

KCTC MEMBERSHIP MEETING 3-15-2026

Dakota Smitley, Dan Goldberg, Jim Gilmore, Kim Gilmore, Linda Irwin, Michale Kuhlman, Bob Powischill, Barb Powischill, Tracey Miller, Maribeth Hook, Brendon Connolly, Susan Wetherell, Katie Hinzman, Bonnie Thomas, Janine Smith, Maria Vighetti, Kenny Royer, Deborah Miller-Gurchak, Lynda Kuzbel, Donna Kuglar, Suzanne Vighetti, Mary Benedetti, Chris Palamone, Lynn Hoskowitz, Lori Ritchey, Pam Heidrich, Jen Heid, Lisa Duncan, Sharon Hareza, Pam Lewis, Amy Rusenko, Amy Sandhagen, Ted Nowlen, Bill Tullock, Dan Mullaney, Clare Schmalz, Michelle Rengers, Juanita Martini, Arlene Boehm

CALL TO ORDER:

Ted Nowlen called the meeting to order. 7:02 PM

Minutes from the January 18, 2026 meeting were approved.

TREASURER'S REPORT

01/31/2026

Previous Balance	\$54,158.20
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Deposits	\$6,540.20
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Checks and Payments	\$9,329.65
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Ending Balance	\$51,368.75
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02/28/2026

Previous Balance	\$51,368.75
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Deposits	\$3,450.53
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Checks and Payments	\$5,093.54
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Ending Balance	\$49,725.74
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MEMBERSHIP REPORT

2 new members were presented for membership.

Kady Durko, Monique Fontaine

TRAINING DIRECTOR'S REPORT

Session 2 started last week and everything is going well

NOMINATING COMMITTEE REPORT

- Bill Tullock is the chair

- Nominations are in March for the election in May
- Following position will be in the upcoming election and the following people have been identified by the committee
 - Vice-President – Tasha Swanson
 - Corresponding Secretary/Membership Chair – Clare Schmalz
 - Training Director – Pam Lewis
 - Director-at-Large (one of the two elected positions) – Amy Rusenko
- Nominees from the floor
 - Vice President – Katie Hinzman
 - Training Director – Suzanne Vighetti
 - Director-at-Large – Chris Palamone
- Bill Tullock stated his displeasure that the people hadn't come to the nominating committee
 - Bob Powischill countered with the inappropriateness of Bill's comment
- Dan Mullaney asked if the nominees were present to accept
 - Nominees were present and each accepted

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

- The Bylaws have been revised, corrected and distributed on March 1, 2026
 - Called for vote to pass the Bylaws, following the below discussion the Bylaws were not approved
 - Janine Smith, Attorney, raised that the Bylaws are like the constitution and that discipline should not be removed and put in the policies. Ted Nowlen asked why she hadn't commented and she explained she wasn't asked and they need to be condensed. Janine had worked with a committee to write them as they are in their current state and there is history. She questioned why no committee or help from the membership. She offered to chair a committee. Ted approved her chairing a committee. Question from the floor on how to volunteer for the committee.
 - Susan Wetherell questioned why she was asked to write of definition of positive reinforcement and negative punishment, after providing information, it was changed. Ted Nowlen said it was changed for brevity in the bylaws and that Susan's version was more appropriate for the Instructor's Manual that Susan had agreed to review at the January meeting. She handed out a side-by-side comparison of what was sent and what appeared in the revised Bylaws. Ted said that Janine and the Bylaws Committee could look at that for consideration.
 - Jen Heid asked why the Board removed her from the Rodeo Dog Committee along with Suzanne Vighetti and Emil Pohodich after they brought Rodeo Dog to Keystone. Ted Nowlen advised committee composition is not a Board decision, committee members are at the discretion of the Chair. Suzanne responded that is not how it feels sitting here. Maribeth Hook asked about reaching out to membership regarding committees. Juanita Martini stated the Board isn't looking good. Marybeth stated more people with different ideas might be better,

transparency issue. Amy Rusenko stated it sounds like a lack of trust and boards doesn't tell everything. Susan stated trust goes both ways and asked to write something then change it. Amy Sandhagen said the Board took care of everything because of lack of membership involvement, for the last 2-3 years there have been fewer members attending the meetings, mainly just the board, until now. Jen shared she stepped forward for the VP position and was told no, there is gatekeeping, want people to volunteer but then the Board appoints. MaryBeth suggested people need to be asked to help, some people just won't step forward. Bill stated the Board of Directors are elected. Janine suggested to get more people involved another means of communication, as not everyone checks email regularly, maybe post on the website and also post the agendas so people will know what will be going on at the meetings. Dan Mullaney stated if it is important then attend meeting regularly, not coming but then complaining doesn't make it seem important. Suzanne then went back to her suggestion for virtual meetings that she suggested in November which would encourage people to be part of the meetings and a way to engage members. Lori Ritchey stated she has volunteered and been part of the club for 30 years, she was asked to help with a class by an instructor but was told no as the club wants new faces, even though she has extensive experience and capabilities in training dogs. How are these decisions being made. Amy Rusenko stated fresh faces because the club was aging and people are getting older. She also stated she likes seeing everybody and that wouldn't happen with virtual meetings. Ted stated the Board makes decisions in the interest of the club, if you don't like the decisions the bylaws provide for the nominate of board members. Each board member has an equal vote and Board decision are seldom unanimous. Amy Sandhagen again stated no one volunteers. Jen responded with then why are people being kicked off committees. Dan Mullaney stated there was no process, so the decision was to appoint a member as the Chair and the committee develops. Lori then questioned the dismissals. Other suggestion included rotating the Chair. Katie Hinzman stated the lack of transparency is concerning. The board will not publicly give reasons for all appointment decisions to spare embarrassment that serves no constructive purpose. Janine stated in 2010 use to list committees and shared information back and forth. Ted said Chairs were appointed to get the committees back in order as there were no official committees and if people want to help it is on the membership form and he state looking at revising the website. Amy Sandhagen agreed that it is better if you talk to people, they are not going to respond to an email regarding volunteering.

Upcoming Trials/Events

- See the Website – WCRL Premium is posted for May 16 & 17 on WCRL and KCTC

Old Business

- The floors were cleaned

New Business

- Front furnace – shutting off
- Website development – working on redesigning
- The grass/snow contract has been changed as the current one was not always showing up in time for classes to begin

AROUND THE TABLE

- Dan Mullaney is looking for volunteers for the WCRL trial, all assistance is welcome

ADJOURNMENT 8:09 PM

Respectfully Submitted

Michelle Rengers, Recording Secretary